

INFORMATION SHEET TO THE STUDY:

Proactive Context Learning

Researcher Information:

Researcher: Julianus Kath

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Research Question:

This study investigates the development and evaluation of an autonomous digital system for enterprise data analysis. The research is guided by the following objectives, whereas the the conducted user study particularly evaluates the third hypothesis (proof of value):

- **Proof of Concept (H1):** To examine whether an autonomous system can be developed that is capable of independently identifying, collecting, and combining data from multiple enterprise data sources in order to generate a technical representation of a company, based on an initial description.
- **Proof of Performance (H2a):** To evaluate whether the system can accurately integrate both structured and unstructured data from different sources and derive meaningful relationships. The system's outputs will be compared with responses provided by qualified human experts to assess accuracy and reliability.
- **Proof of Application (H2b):** To assess whether the system functions effectively not only in a simulated or test environment, but also when applied within real companies and real-world data contexts.
- **Proof of Value (H3):** To investigate whether the system provides practical value for strategic decision-making. This will be evaluated by observing how decision-makers interact with the system and by collecting their feedback using established evaluation instruments (e.g., UTAUT2, NASA Task Load Index).

Abstract of the Project:

This thesis presents a methodology and implementation of a Proactive Context Learning system in enterprise environments. The objective is to develop an autonomous system that is placed in an enterprise context and then discovers, prioritizes, crawls, and fuses heterogeneous data sources (e.g., ERP, CRM) in order to generate a technical model of the company's infrastructure. Based on the learned-holistic-context, the system provides valuable responses on questions about the company (e.g., sales, marketing) that are asked by experts in the business domain of the enterprise (e.g., C-level functions). This approach seeks to address limitations associated with traditional rule-based and manually configured systems by offering an unsupervised, adaptable, and scalable solution. The system's performance will be evaluated based on its ability to produce measurable outcomes that support strategic decision-making.

Information regarding data:

Data Collection

- The data that is collected from these interviews will be in the form of audio and video (screen recording). This is solely for the purpose of transcription and behaviour analysis, which is required for the qualitative analysis of the interview, to gain a valid insight on the subject matter to answer the above research question. The knowledge gained from the interviews will aid in evaluating the hypothesis H3 (Proof of Value) to determine the value generated in real world scenarios.

Data Protection

- The transcription service used for the audio recording will be “Fireflies.AI” (<https://fireflies.ai>) and may be saved anonymously (real name obfuscated with a participant ID). The screen recording will be done using the MacOS-native tool “QuickTime Player”. To be compliant with GDPR standards, the data will be saved on the local drive of the executive researcher and will be immediately stored on MicroSoft OneDrive, which is regulated by the University and is GDPR compliant. The data will be deleted after the submission of the Thesis.

Data Storage

- The data will be stored confidentially, but not anonymously unless specifically requested by the participant. This is because the recordings will be saved for transcription purposes. Transcription data will be anonymised, unless selected differently in the consent form. Anonymity means the link to the personal data will be destroyed and the participants cannot be identified via their voice or behaviour, as it will no longer exist – only the transcription of the interview will remain. The data will not be stored in a coded format (eg Participant1) to keep track of the interviews. If selected, the transcription will also not make any mention of the name, job title or institution title.
- The video and audio data will not be stored any longer than necessary and will be destroyed within a year. This is also subject to the participants wishes. The researcher (Julianus Kath) will be responsible for the management of the data.

Publication of the paper (white paper)

- The academic thesis may be published in full or in parts as a publicly available white or academic paper, without modification to its content, unless anonymization is explicitly requested in the consent form.
- The publication may include non-anonymized content, such as the name of the participating organization or attributable statements, provided that the participant has explicitly agreed to such disclosure. If no such agreement is given, all published material will be anonymized to prevent identification.
- Direct quotations from the study may be used for illustrative purposes. These will be attributed only with the participant’s explicit consent as selected in the attached consent form; otherwise, they will be anonymized and, where necessary, edited to prevent identification.

Participation in this study implies consent to the use of the research results for the purposes described above. Participants retain the right to request anonymization or to withdraw their consent prior to publication, in which case their data will not be included in any published material.

If there are any questions or concerns regarding the study, please reach out to the researcher Julianus Kath.

The following page (page 3) will contain the Consent Form that must be signed prior to the Interviews being conducted.

CONSENT FORM

for participation in the scientific research study: "*Proactive Context Learning*".

Statement of participant

The aim of the research study has been outlined to me. I was given the opportunity to ask questions regarding the research study. I participate voluntarily in the research study. I understand that I can stop at any point during the research study, should I wish to do so. I understand how the data of the research study will be stored and how they will be used. I consent to participating in the research study as described in the information document.

In addition, by participating in this study, I consent to the collection and analysis of audio recordings (including transcription) as well as screen recordings, and to the publication of the study results as part of an academic thesis at the University of St. Gallen and in the form of a publicly accessible white paper (e.g. via Corpln GmbH), unless I explicitly object to or request anonymization.

Name:

Signature:

Date:

Statement of executive researcher

I declare that I have informed the above-mentioned person correctly about the research study and that I abide by the guidelines for research at University of St. Gallen.

Name: Julianus Kath

Signature: 

Date: January 12th, 2026